



Profile

Personal Information

Name Kariuki, Sydney *Karimi*
Preferred Name Sydney
Sex, Birthdate Female, 02/06/2001

Contact Details

Email, Phone kariukisidney9@gmail.com, +254.740389960, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent Address P.O. BOX 5423 NAIROBI, 00506, KEN
Alternate Address P.O. BOX 606 VILLAGE MARKET US EMBASSY, NAIROBI, 00621, KEN

Demographics

Military Status None
Hispanic or Latino No
Race Black or African American (Africa)

Language

English First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Gikuyu Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home

Geography & Citizenship

Citizenship Status Other (Non-US)
Birthplace Nairobi, Kenya (0 Years US, 18 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships Kenya
Current US Visa None
Intended US Visa F-1 Student

CA Fee Waiver

Fee Waiver Requested No

Family

Household

Parents Married
Home Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name Mr. Geoffrey K Kiboro
Birthplace Kenya
Email, Phone gkkiboro@gmail.com, +254.722762263, Mobile
Address the same as my home address
Occupation Other, Banking, Employed, Bank Official, Consolidated Bank
Education Some trade school or community college
Bachelors (1990), **Moi University, Eldoret, Eldoret, KEN**

Parent 2

Mother

Name Mrs. Rebecca M Kariuki (Ndeke)
Birthplace Kenya
Email, Phone becky.kariuki@gmail.com, +254.763708872, Mobile
Address the same as my home address
Occupation Laborer, Unemployed
Education Graduated from trade school or community college
Bachelors (2012), **Kenya Methodist University, Nairobi, Nairobi, KEN**

Siblings

1. Kenneth K Kariuki, Age 20, Brother, Some trade school or community college, Bachelors, (09/2018 - 06/2021), **Strathmore University, Nairobi, Nairobi, KEN**

Education

Current or Most Recent Secondary School

St. Bakhita Bahati Girls, P.O. BOX 1648, Nakuru, Nakuru, KEN, Public (02/2015 - 11/2018)

Counselor Mr. James N Ndiritu, Career Counsellor
Email, Phone jamesndiritu45@gmail.com, +254.721278782
Boarding School Yes: Living at School
Progression Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date 11/2018

Colleges & Universities

Grades

Rank 2 / 192, Unweighted
GPA 81 , Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

First Trimester	Second Trimester	Third Trimester
Mathematics - (REG)	Mathematics - (REG)	Mathematics - (REG)
English - (REG)	English - (REG)	English - (REG)
Swahili - (REG)	Swahili - (REG)	Swahili - (REG)
Chemistry - (REG)	Chemistry - (REG)	Chemistry - (REG)
Biology - (REG)	Biology - (REG)	Biology - (REG)
Physics - (REG)	Physics - (REG)	Physics - (REG)
Homescience - (REG)	Homescience - (REG)	Homescience - (REG)
Christian Religious Education - (REG)	Christian Religious Education - (REG)	Christian Religious Education - (REG)

Honors

Semifinalist in the National Mathematics Olympiad	National	12
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Highest Chemistry scores in the regional examinations in Nakuru County	State/Regional	11
Honors student award for exemplary yearly performance	School	10, 11, 12
In the top 150 in the Kenya National Examinations out of 660,204 students	National	12
3rd place in the DigiGirlz Microsoft innovation Challenge	National	11

Community-Based Organizations

CBO 1	EducationUSA
Counselor	Ms. Faith Biko
Email, Phone	BikoFN@state.gov, +254.708285296
CBO 2	Equity Leadership Program

Future Plans

Engineer, Doctorate

Testing

SAT (March 2016 or after)

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	770	05/05/2019
Math	710	05/05/2019
Essay	16	05/05/2019
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	Yes	

SAT Subject Tests

Chemistry	790	10/2019
Math Level 1	770	10/2019

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
English	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Kiswahili	B+	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Chemistry	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Physics	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Christian Religious Education	A-	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Homescience	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Biology	B+	11/2018, Actual, KCSE

Activities

Internship

PG	Relationship Officer, Equity Bank Limited
Year	Responsible for opening bank accounts, printing bank statements and facilitating the debit card business. My income supplemented the family income
56 hr/wk, 28 wk/yr	
Continue	

Computer/Technology

11	Project Manager, Safaricom Technovation Challenge
School	In charge of execution of the Med-lance project. Made a prototype that would make ambulance services more affordable and accessible to more people
20 hr/wk, 12 wk/yr	
Continue	

Science/Math

10, 11, 12	Assistant Chairlady, STEM Honors Society
School, Break	Tutored and mentored an average of 100 students with difficulties in Mathematics and Chemistry concepts, to help promote a continuing interest in STEM
7 hr/wk, 32 wk/yr	
Continue	

Science/Math

10, 11	Participant, Kenya Science and Engineering Fair
School	Developed a prototype of an improvement of the school's water filtration system to help combat water-borne diseases. 3rd runners up nationally
5 hr/wk, 27 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11	Head Volunteer, Red Cross
School	Volunteered at events as a first-responder in-training, assisted the patron in recruitments, organizing fundraisers and preparing training programs
3 hr/wk, 25 wk/yr	
Continue	

Student Govt./Politics

10, 11	President, Peer Guidance and Counselling Club
School	Provided one-on-one confidential support to WCS students, organized for training of peer counsellors and gave presentations on harmful effects of drug
3 hr/wk, 26 wk/yr	
Continue	

Other Club/Activity

10, 11, 12	Founder, The Entertainment Committee
Year	I organized entertainment acts during school functions, controlled the PA system and spearheaded a 2-day cultural festival to enhance cultural embrace
2 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr	
Continue	

Cultural

9	Treasurer and participant, National Music Festival
School, Break	I participated in the traditional folk dances and the English and Swahili choral verses to learn more about my culture, ranking no. 6 nation-wide
10 hr/wk, 16 wk/yr	
Continue	

Journalism/Publication

10, 11	Vice President and co-editor, Press Club
School	Led club meetings, arranged club events at community venues, took part in publishing of the editorial column and initiated the very first soup kitchen
2 hr/wk, 20 wk/yr	
Continue	

Student Govt./Politics

10, 11, 12	Member, Regional Student Council
School	Gave presentations at school meetings on behalf of the committee, arranged and organized for retreats, and attended meetings once a month
2 hr/wk, 26 wk/yr	
Continue	

Writing

Personal Essay

Share an essay on any topic of your choice. It can be one you've already written, one that responds to a different prompt, or one of your own design.

My story is a collection of stories. A collection of experiences that gave birth to a collection of feelings that spurred into a collection of emotions. All of them based on the "chemicals of life", or maybe lack thereof. Acetylcholine, Serotonin, and Dopamine. See, most of us go about our daily lives not giving much thought to why we do the things we do, but I yearned for more, and so I sought for it. I started connecting certain chemicals to certain behaviors and in so doing, learnt much more about myself.

Serotonin; satisfaction, happiness, wellbeing. It is unclear whether low serotonin levels contribute to depression, or if depression causes a fall in serotonin levels. Either way, I could not ignore the harsh reality, I was depressed. Or so my 17-year-old self thought. As I sat in the backseat of a dingy matatu (minivan), squished in between a mother holding her wailing child and a grumpy old man, I could not help but grunt at the fact that I did not get a window seat. Wind in my face, a window seat provided a sort of escape from the dreary realities of life. The realities of coming home to an ailing mother, wrinkles appearing on her tired face as she welcomed me home. Dealing with hypothyroidism, she was ill more often than not, and the hospital became our second home. She would call in sick to work most days, and day by day, the figures on the hospital bills became more and more worrying. But I tried not to let this phase me. I still woke up every day as I always had, fetched water from the well as I always did, went to work on the farm as usual. But today, on my way to do what was probably the most important exam of my life, I did not get a window seat.

Acetylcholine; driving, learning. I have learned over the years; life is a test. A test of our priorities and convictions, our faith and our faithfulness, our patience and our resilience, and eventually, our ultimate desires. But on the 28th of November 2018, all this did not matter because all I could remember was how to calculate electric current and how I did not need this formula at all. I had learned a lot over the years, and during my last high school test, when I needed it the most, I froze, simply because, my mother had a surgery that day and amidst all the books and formulas and alphas and betas, I forgot. I forgot to go on my knees and say a daily prayer for her and I forgot that she needed me to do well, for me and for her. So, I took a seat, closed my eyes and envisioned a window seat. A window seat not of a bus, or a minivan, or even a train, but of a window of endless possibilities, and with renewed strength altogether, I stood up and did that exam like my life depended on it.

Dopamine; the feel-good hormone. Dopamine is associated with feelings of euphoria, bliss, motivation, and concentration. And all of these are what I felt as I stepped onto a podium to speak to hundreds of parents about why I was the way I was; why my spirit refused to give up, and how they should encourage their children to do the same. I had just received my exam results and as was inconceivable to my young mind, I was leading in my village. I had gone through hell and back, and as I breathed into the microphone, a myriad of eyes staring back at me, I recalled it all and resolved that I wouldn't have had it any other way. "Set your priorities straight," I started.

Education Progression

Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

Required Explanation

Education progression

In Kenya, high school graduates must wait for a period of 10 months or more before joining university. After completing high school, I started studying a short course, the first unit of Association of Chartered Certified Accountants (ACCA) in December. I continued up until January where, shortly after the release of the national examination results, I was offered an internship at Equity Bank Limited where I have worked as a part-time Junior Relationship Officer for 5 months. I therefore put my studies on hold temporarily.

At Equity bank, I worked in the front office where I would open accounts, print bank statements and deal with debit card business. I was also recruited into the marketing team. I worked here up until the end of August when my contract terminated. In February, I joined the Education USA program, which is a mentorship program that aids scholars in the preparation of SATs and takes them through the application process to universities in the United States of America. Through this program, I learnt a lot on universities abroad from the information sessions that would be held, and continue to broaden my knowledge on essay writing and admission interviews.

In addition to this, I volunteer as a mentor to students in my former secondary school. Every 2 weeks, I assist them in their preparation for the Kenya Science and Engineering Fair by helping them work on their projects and by offering support when needed. I also participate in the church choir and youth service.

Disciplinary Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

University of Pennsylvania Questions

General

Start Term	Fall 2020
Admission plan	Early Decision
School Specific Fee Waivers	No
Financial aid	Yes
Early Decision Agreement	Yes, I have read and understand my rights and responsibilities under the Early Decision Process and have reviewed Penn's Early Decision policy. I wish to be considered as an Early Decision candidate at University of Pennsylvania. I also understand that with an Early Decision offer of admissions, this institution may share my name and my early commitment with other institutions. SYDNEY KARIMI KARIUKI
University of Pennsylvania allows submission of an external portfolio so that your special talent in one or more of the arts will be considered as part of the admission process. Do you plan to submit one to University of Pennsylvania?	No

Have you ever been adjudicated guilty or convicted of a misdemeanor or felony? Penn does not prejudge individuals on the basis of their response to this question; however, we want to understand the circumstances around your criminal history. We urge applicants to reflect upon their actions, provide context and detail, and any lessons learned from the experience.

No

Academics

Primary School/Program to Which You Are Applying School of Engineering & Applied Science

Primary Major of Interest Engineering (choice of field deferred to sophomore year)

Contacts

Previously applied No

How have you learned about University of Pennsylvania? List in order of influence Internet

If you wish to be contacted via mobile phone, please provide your phone number. Contact methods may include phone calls generated from an automated telephone dialing system or text messaging.

I consent to be contacted by University of Pennsylvania at the mobile phone number provided below.

Mobile Phone Number: +254.740389960

Family

Sibling applied No

Relatives attended member No

Relative employed at member No

Other Information

Do you hold permanent residence status in Canada or Mexico? No

Identity Details No

Would you like to provide information regarding personal identification with the LGBTQ+ community? (optional) No

By submitting this application, you certify that this application and its contents are factually true, honestly presented, and authentic. Additional application materials sent on your behalf (e.g., transcripts, counselor recommendations, etc.) must be sent by an official or University-approved source. All application materials and contents are subject to audit and verification. In cases of applicant misrepresentation, including falsifications or deliberate omissions, Penn Admissions reserves the right to deny or rescind admission. I agree

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here:
<http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.